

EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Applied economist who turns difficult quantitative questions into defensible research designs, reproducible evidence systems, and explanations decision-makers can use. Ph.D. training in economics, quantitative psychology, and geographic information science supports work across public finance, labor, trade, critical-technology assessment, and spatial measurement. Teaching spans introductory through doctoral and executive audiences; coaching spans coursework, applied analysis, and end-to-end research design.

TRANSFERABLE VALUE

RESEARCH DESIGN

Turns ambiguous mandates into estimands, data architectures, identification strategies, robustness plans, and appropriately bounded claims.

QUANTITATIVE COACHING

Guides students, doctoral researchers, working professionals, and executive-level clients through economics, econometrics, statistics, research design, Python, SQL, Stata, and GIS.

EVIDENCE ENGINEERING

Builds inspectable pipelines linking sources, transformations, models, tables, figures, decision logs, and public evidence products.

TRANSLATION AND JUDGMENT

Explains assumptions, uncertainty, failure modes, and decision consequences without flattening the underlying technical problem.

SELECTED RESEARCH AND EVIDENCE SYSTEMS

The Rural Mobilization Gap in a U.S. Place-Based Tax Credit

Sole-authored working paper; original study by Ian Helfrich | Project contributors: Katia Antunes and Elizaveta Gonchar | August 2026

- Built an auditable project-level panel from 19,907 CDFI Fund transactions covering 8,024 New Markets Tax Credit projects, \$66.6 billion in qualified low-income community investments, and \$120.9 billion in total project cost.
- Used fixed effects, an order-invariant Gelbach decomposition, quantile methods, clustered inference, bootstrap tests, margins, and subgroup diagnostics. In the purpose-augmented decomposition, CDE identity accounts for 88.1% of the explained movement; the design is explicitly noncausal.
- Linked source hashes, model outputs, manuscript values, tables, figures, and a public evidence viewer so readers can inspect both findings and limits.

Human or Machine? Out-of-Time Validation of Task-Level AI Exposure Ratings

Sole-authored working paper | August 2026

- Linked 19,265 occupation-task records across 923 occupations to six later public task-use measures; compared trained-human and GPT-4 ratings with within-occupation models and paired cluster bootstraps.
- Identified and rejected a mechanically circular validation path, keeping measurement-validity findings separate from unsupported employment-effect claims.

Trade in the Spotlight

With Elizaveta Gonchar | SSRN 5202676 | 2025 preprint

Constructed annual population- and nightlight-weighted distance measures and evaluated their contribution to gravity models of interstate and international trade.

PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE

Independent Economist and Quantitative Researcher | Self-directed and collaborative applied research 2024-present

Lead work from problem definition and data construction through econometric analysis, adversarial robustness testing, technical writing, and inspectable research products.

Independent Quantitative Instructor & Research-Design Coach | Wyzant and direct practice 2021-present

- Tutor and coach across economics, econometrics, statistics, finance, strategy, quantitative marketing, research methods, Python, SQL, Stata, and GIS, from AP/IB through graduate, doctoral, professional, and executive-level work.
- More than 1,035 hours through Wyzant as of August 2026, with a 5.0/5 public rating; nearly 1,000 additional direct tutoring and executive-level research-design coaching hours outside the platform.

Independent Economic Advisor | Industrial-sector diagnostics 2026-present

Developed a diagnostic methodology spanning growth constraints, indicator selection and sequencing, composite-index construction, and international benchmarking.

TEACHING AND EXECUTIVE EDUCATION

Instructor of Record & Graduate Teaching Assistant Georgia Institute of Technology	doctoral appointment
• Instructor of record for three semesters: ECON 2100 twice and ECON 2106; also led sections, recitations, assessment, and grading across undergraduate economics. • Georgia Tech Economics Graduate Teaching Assistant of the Year, 2023.	
Graduate Teaching Fellow Georgia Tech Center for Teaching and Learning	2018-19
Selected for the inaugural cohort; designed professional-development curriculum and co-led orientation for new and returning teaching assistants and instructors.	
Teaching Support Duke University Global Executive MBA	2016-17
Supported managerial economics, strategy, and global-markets instruction for an executive audience.	
Graduate Teaching Assistant Indiana University Bloomington	2015-16
Supported undergraduate economics instruction before completing graduate study in economics.	
Online Instructor Campus / MTI College cohorts	2022-23
Taught Principles of Microeconomics in Summer and Fall 2022 and Principles of Macroeconomics in Spring 2023.	

LEARNING SYSTEMS AND QUANTITATIVE TRANSLATION

REUSABLE METHODS LIBRARIES	EXECUTABLE QUANTITATIVE PRACTICE
Builds modular curricula across statistics, inference, econometrics, microeconomics, and macroeconomics, with concepts separated from software-specific implementation.	Builds browser-native exercises, frozen teaching datasets, regression workflows, public-data labs, and familiar statistical output across Excel, Stata, R, Julia, Python, and SQL.
DIAGNOSTIC AND EXECUTIVE LEARNING DESIGN	VISUAL METHODS
Designs criterion-referenced diagnostics and decision-centered coaching in quantitative methods, finance, strategy, and marketing, with explicit boundaries on what an assessment can support.	<i>Pictures of Inference</i> , with Elizaveta Gonchar: book project in progress; Part One chapters 1-10 drafted as of August 14, 2026.

POLICY, TECHNOLOGY ASSESSMENT AND LEADERSHIP

- **National Network for Critical Technology Assessment (2023):** additional contributor to the semiconductor demonstration in *Securing America’s Future: A Framework for Critical Technology Assessment*, an NSF-sponsored national report.
- **Professional service:** Referee, *Journal of Economic Theory*, 2025.
- **Georgia Tech Graduate Student Government (2018-20):** Vice President for Campus Services and graduate senator; coauthored a policy white paper and represented graduate students in cross-campus planning; Senator of the Year, 2020.

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Economics , Georgia Institute of Technology Minor: Quantitative Psychology	2024
M.S., Geographic Information Science and Technology , Georgia Institute of Technology	2022
M.S., Economics , Georgia Institute of Technology	2019
M.A., Economics , Indiana University Bloomington	2018
M.Sc., Specialized Economic Analysis , Barcelona School of Economics Economics and Public Policy	2015
B.A., Economics , University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill	2014

METHODS AND TECHNICAL PRACTICE

Methods: research design; panel and fixed-effects models; Gelbach decomposition; event studies; quantile and median regression; clustered and bootstrap inference; measurement validation; geospatial, network, trade, and public-program analysis; data provenance; technical reporting and visualization.

Tools: R; Python; SQL (SQLite, DuckDB); Stata; Julia; QGIS/ArcGIS Pro; Git; LaTeX, Typst, and Quarto.

Selected work and current research: ihelfrich.github.io · Reproducible NMTC project: github.com/ihelfrich/us-nmtc-viewer